

CEAP Online Meeting Report

30 May 2026

The online meeting started on time and proceeded smoothly, hosted by **Dr. Wang Bowen**.

In his opening remarks, **Prof. Neil Roberts** emphasised the significance of CEAP (the Chinese European Association for Poetry and Poetics) and expressed his hope that the organisation would develop into a vibrant community connecting scholars, poets, translators, and students across continents.

Prof. Charles Bernstein could not make the meeting, so he has provided a written version of his opening remarks, as attached.

Prof. Li Zhimin gave a brief introduction to CEAP according to the CEAP Blurb that had been sent all CEAP members. He stressed that the basic principle behind the operation of CEAP is a distribution of responsibilities. In other words, each member will hopefully contribute to the development of CEAP according to the role one is playing. He suggested a simple website or a blog that serves as a newsletter for CEAP be constructed very soon. Any advice on this is welcome! He also suggested an academic journal for CEAP be created when it is time. Any information on how to get a good press to publish it is appreciated.

Dr. Lei Yanni gave a brief introduction to EPSI (the English Poetry Studies Institute at Sun Yat-sen University), host of the 2026 CEAP conference. She invited anyone who has received a sealed official invitation to buy their own flight tickets and then contact her or Ms. Zhuang Jianbin in order to receive a cash refund in Chinese yuan at the conference. Alternatively, they can send over exact dates and request that EPSI buy the flight tickets. If dates need to be changed after tickets have been bought, a fee will apply.

Ms. Zhuang Jianbin offered to organise a lecture or a seminar to be given by those who would like to stay for extra nights before or after the conference. Academics giving a lecture or seminar are often provided one or two nights of free accommodation in addition to an honorarium of 2000–3000 yuan. The honorarium could cover a few more nights, as each night at Sun Yat-sen University Kaifeng Hotel costs around 500 to 600 yuan after discount. She also recommended participants begin preparations well in advance.

Prof. Adam Piette spoke briefly of his plan to host the second CEAP conference in Sheffield in 2027.

Prof. Andrea Brady, Prof. Daniel Katz, Prof. Zhang Yuejun, Mr. Max Heuvels, and Mr. Charlie Standen introduced themselves, shared their current research interests, expressed their hopes for CEAP, and raised a few questions about logistics.

Unfortunately, a few people were locked out of the meeting room owing to technical difficulties, which our CEAP secretary Dr. Wang Bowen has responded with offer of assistance.

The international road for our joint venture of CEAP might be full of bumps, here and there, which shall only please people who enjoy challenges!

CEAP Secretary Office
3 June 2026

P.S.

Prof. Charles Bernstein's Opening Remarks

I first met Li Zhimin in July 2007 at the International Conference on Twentieth-Century American Poetry in Wuhan. We were co-MCs for a Chinese and American poetry reading, the grand finale of the gathering. Sitting side by side, introducing one poet after another, we began to find a rhythm—syncopated, improvised, antiphonal. Nearly twenty years later, we're still keeping that time.

It's the rhythm of encounter—not East meeting West, but two poet-scholars discovering a shared measure. In those moments, Zhimin and I inhabit a virtual country, neither East nor West. Following Robin Blaser, I call it ImagiNation: a place made not of territory but conversation, not of borders but crossings.

Out of that first Wuhan conference came many further encounters. In 2011, Nie Zhenzhao, Luo Lianggong, Marjorie Perloff, and I joined together to found CAAP—the Chinese American Association of Poetry and Poetics. Since then, we have met again and again, in person and online, creating what feels less like an organization than an ongoing conversation. Over these years, I have had the good fortune to work with many visiting Chinese scholars at the University of Pennsylvania; Zhimin himself has been in residence at Penn twice.

What continues to astonish me is the extraordinary engagement with poetry among Chinese scholars — not only American poetry but poetry across English and European languages. That commitment has created a vital zone of exchange, translation, scholarship, and reimagination. Which brings us to the Chinese and European Association of Poetry and Poetics. CEAP is a welcome complement to CAAP, extending the conversation and widening the circle. Another outpost of ImagiNation.

Let our conversations become syncretic, polyphonic, contrapuntal! To glimpse how such encounters have shaped the past century, take a look at Li Zhimin and Daniel Braun's *China Being Led and Leading*, which traces a history of mutual influence and unexpected crossings stretching back more than a hundred years—a history we share, whether we know it or not.

We are not building bridges between cultures; we are making a place where the bridge itself is a dwelling.

Our encounters will take place online and in person, in China and in Europe. Where I live, in Brooklyn, New York, it's 12 hours difference from China, so 12 is 12 and 5 is 5. "Which is the day before?" and "AM or PM?" are hard for a person afflicted with topsy-turvy. But somehow, muddling through, we will all end up turvy-top.